APPSC GROUP 1 / GROUP 2 — GEOGRAPHY
Volume 3: Geography of Andhra Pradesh

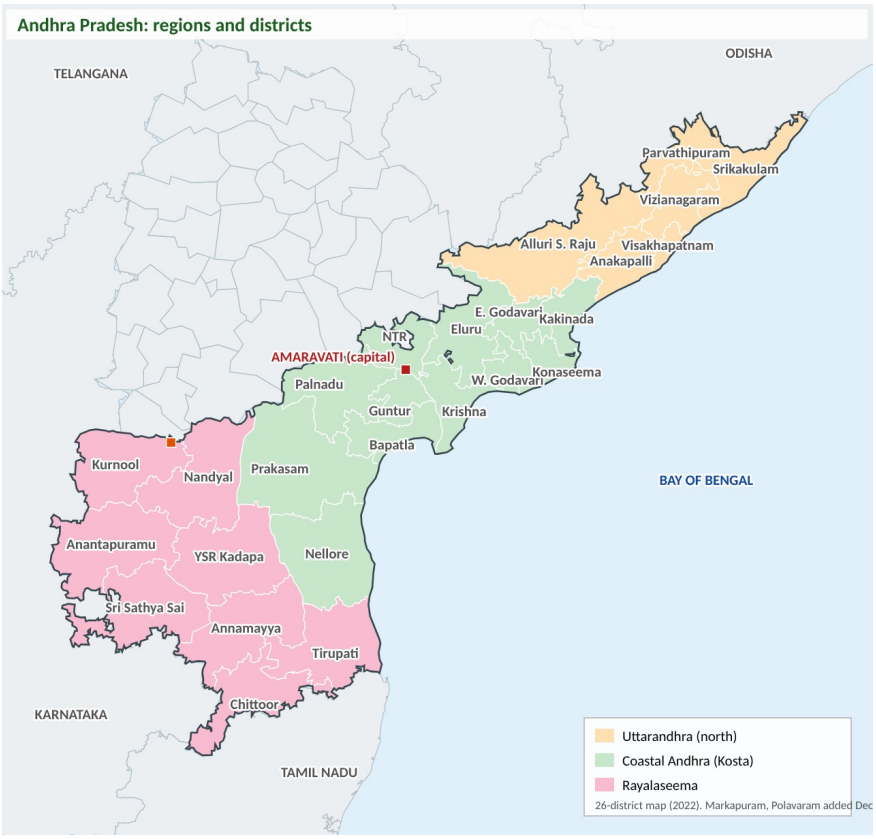
Location and Regions · Land, Rivers, Climate (recap) · Irrigation · Agriculture · Minerals and Energy · Industries and Ports · Transport · People and Tribes

READ THIS FIRST

How to use: same colours as Volumes 1-2: **Blue** = simple explanation · **Orange** = Kurnool / Rayalaseema link · **Red** = exam traps · **Green** = 2-minute revision · **Purple** = self-check. Volume 2 gave the physical base of India and AP; this volume is **Andhra Pradesh only** and is the most scoring part of the Geography syllabus for you.
Study plan (5 days): Day 1 Ch 1-2 · Day 2 Ch 3 (water) · Day 3 Ch 4 (crops) · Day 4 Ch 5-6 (minerals, industry, ports) · Day 5 Ch 7-8 + final test.
Checked facts: districts (28 from 31 Dec 2025), SCoR railway zone (started 1 June 2026), Amaravati statutory capital (Act notified 7 April 2026), NSTR area (about 3,728 sq km), coastline (974 km, official AP figure). Items marked **(verify)** change often; recheck in the latest current affairs.

CHAPTER 1 — ANDHRA PRADESH: LOCATION, REGIONS AND DISTRICTS

The state in one page



Map 1.1 Regions and districts (26-district base map; Markapuram and Polavaram were added on 31 Dec 2025)

IN SIMPLE WORDS (what / how / why)

Where: south-east India, between about **12.6°N–19.9°N** and **76.7°E–84.8°E**, entirely south of the Tropic of Cancer (so a **tropical** state). **Area about 1,62,970 sq km, about 7th largest state (verify). Coastline about 974 km, second longest after Gujarat** (the state's official figure; newer surveys differ).
Neighbours: Telangana (north-west), **Chhattisgarh and Odisha** (north), **Tamil Nadu** (south), **Karnataka** (west/south-west), **Bay of Bengal** (east). **Yanam** (Puducherry's enclave) lies inside the Godavari delta.
Capital: Amaravati, on the south bank of the **Krishna** near Vijayawada and Guntur. The **AP Reorganisation (Amendment) Act, 2026** (notified **7 April 2026**; deemed in force from 2 June 2024) names Amaravati the state's capital by law.
Three cultural regions: Uttarandhra (north: Srikakulam, Vizianagaram, Visakhapatnam side, with the Eastern Ghats), **Coastal Andhra / Kosta** (Godavari, Krishna, Guntur and Prakasam deltas and plains), and **Rayalaseema** (south-west dry plateau).
Rayalaseema = 'land of the Rayas' (the name was adopted in 1928); the area was the **'Ceded Districts'** given by the Nizam to the British in 1800 (Kurnool, Kadapa, Anantapur, Bellary).

How the state was made (very important for the exam)

Year	Event
1 Oct 1953	**Andhra State** formed from Madras State (after Potti Sriramulu's fast unto death in 1952); **Kurnool** was its capital (1953-56); first CM **T. Prakasam**.
1 Nov 1956	**Andhra Pradesh** formed by merging Andhra State with the Telugu-speaking part of Hyderabad State (**States Reorganisation Act 1956**); capital **Hyderabad**.
2 Jun 2014	**AP Reorganisation Act, 2014**: **Telangana** carved out (10 districts); Hyderabad common capital for up to 10 years; special provisions (Polavaram as national project, etc.).
4 Apr 2022	**13 → 26 districts** (new districts such as Nandyal, Sri Sathya Sai, Annamayya, Tirupati, NTR, Konaseema).
31 Dec 2025	**Markapuram and Polavaram** formed → **28 districts**.

ANDHRA PRADESH / KURNOOL CONNECTION

Kurnool was the **capital of Andhra State (1953-56)**, so it appears in history, polity and geography questions. Today the old Kurnool district is split into **Kurnool** and **Nandyal** (2022); both are in **Rayalaseema**, a **semi-arid** region on the **Deccan plateau** with black cotton soil.
Kurnool town stands on the **Tungabhadra**, close to its confluence with the Krishna at **Sangameswaram**, and on **NH 44** (Srinagar–Kanyakumari highway). It is the 'gateway of Rayalaseema' on the Hyderabad–Bengaluru route.

EXAM TRAPS

Capital of Andhra State (1953) = **Kurnool**, not Hyderabad. Capital of AP now = **Amaravati**.
AP coastline = **974 km, second longest (Gujarat first)**.
Present districts = **28** (since 31 Dec 2025); many books still say 13 or 26.

2-MINUTE REVISION

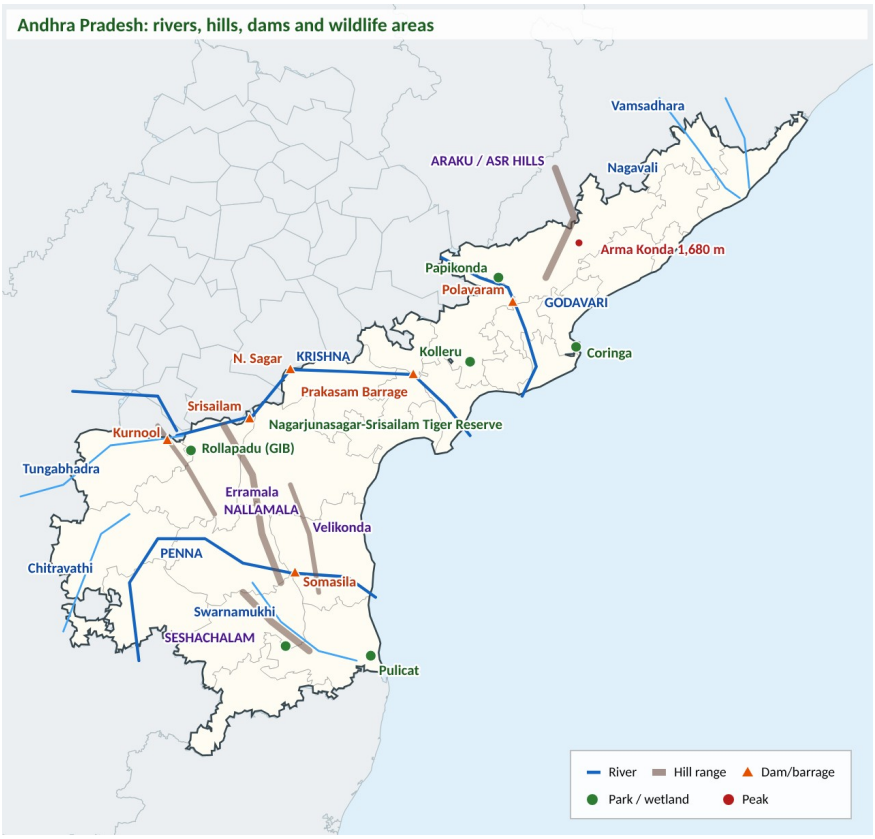
AP lies 12.6°-19.9°N; 7 neighbours/sides; coast 974 km (2nd).
Regions: Uttarandhra, Coastal Andhra, Rayalaseema.
Dates: 1 Oct 1953 → 1 Nov 1956 → 2 Jun 2014 → 4 Apr 2022 (26) → 31 Dec 2025 (28).

CHECK YOURSELF

Q1. First capital of Andhra State: **Kurnool** · Q2. District count today: **28** · Q3. 'Ceded Districts' were given to the British by: **the Nizam (1800)**

CHAPTER 2 — LAND, RIVERS, CLIMATE, SOILS (AP RECAP)

Volume 2 gave the theory; here it is AP only



Map 2.1 Rivers, hills, dams and wildlife areas of AP (schematic)

IN SIMPLE WORDS (what / how / why)

Three landform zones: (1) Eastern Ghats / hill region (north-east: **Araku, Alluri Sitarama Raju hills**; **Arma Konda 1,680 m** is the highest point of AP; central **Nallamala**; south **Seshachalam, Velikonda, Palkonda**). **(2) Rayalaseema plateau** (low, rocky, 200-600 m, with ranges like **Erramala**). **(3) Coastal plain** (wide, flat; **Godavari and Krishna deltas** are among India's finest rice lands).
Rivers: east-flowing, ending in the Bay of Bengal. **Big three: Godavari, Krishna, Penna. North coastal: Vamsadhara, Nagavali** (Eastern Ghats origin). **Tributary: Tungabhadra** (joins the Krishna near Kurnool). Most are **seasonal** except the Godavari and Krishna in their lower reaches.
Climate: tropical monsoon / savanna; summers very hot (40-45°C), **SW monsoon** (Jun-Sep) and an **important NE monsoon** (Oct-Dec) on the south and coastal belt; **cyclones in Oct-Nov**. **Rayalaseema** (Anantapur, Kurnool, Kadapa) lies in the **rain shadow** of the Western Ghats and is **semi-arid**, the driest region of AP.
Soils: red (most widespread), **black** (Kurnool, Anantapur, Guntur, Prakasam), **alluvial** (deltas), **laterite** (Eastern Ghats), **coastal sands and saline** soils. **Natural vegetation:** mostly **dry deciduous** and scrub; **mangroves at Coringa**; **Red Sanders** in the Seshachalam-Nallamala belt.

Wildlife area	Where	Why it matters
Nagarjunasagar-Srisailam Tiger Reserve (NSTR)	Nandyal, Palnadu, Prakasam (AP side) with Telangana's Amrabad	**Largest tiger reserve of India by area, about 3,728 sq km**; Krishna passes through it; Chenchu tribe homeland
Rollapadu WLS	Kurnool/Nandyal	**Great Indian Bustard** (critically endangered) and blackbuck
Coringa WLS	Kakinada (Godavari delta)	Mangroves, fishing cat, Godavari delta
Kolleru, Pulicat	Eluru; Tirupati-Nellore	Kolleru: **Ramsar** freshwater lake; **Pulicat**: second largest brackish lagoon (after Chilika)
Seshachalam Hills Biosphere Reserve	Tirupati-Kadapa	AP's only biosphere reserve; **Red Sanders**, endemic and heavily smuggled
Papikonda NP, Sri Venkateswara NP	Godavari gorge; Tirupati	Scenic gorge; Eastern Ghats forest

ANDHRA PRADESH / KURNOOL CONNECTION

Kurnool-Nandyal: the **Nallamala** hills (forest, tigers, **Chenchu** tribe) and the **Erramala** ridge frame the district; the **Krishna** (Srisailam) forms the north-east edge and the **Tungabhadra** the north. **Banaganapalle** (Nandyal) has the famous **Banganapalli mango** (GI tag) and **Belum Caves** (Kolimigundla) are one of the longest cave systems on the plains of the Indian subcontinent. **Rollapadu** protects the **Great Indian Bustard**.
Drought and heat: Rayalaseema gets **less than 600 mm** in many years and sees **heat waves**; **lightning** is a major cause of death in the monsoon (APSDMA issues SMS warnings).

2-MINUTE REVISION

Highest point Arma Konda 1,680 m. Rivers: Godavari, Krishna, Penna, Tungabhadra (tributary), Vamsadhara, Nagavali.
NSTR largest tiger reserve (3,728 sq km). Seshachalam only biosphere reserve. Rollapadu = GIB.
Rayalaseema semi-arid; coast gets cyclones and NE monsoon.

CHAPTER 3 — WATER AND IRRIGATION IN ANDHRA PRADESH

AP is a state of canals in the east and tanks and lifts in the west

IN SIMPLE WORDS (what / how / why)

Why irrigation matters here: monsoon rain is **erratic**, and Rayalaseema is semi-arid. So the state depends on **canals** (delta districts), **tanks** (old village ponds, Rayalaseema and Chittoor), **tube wells** and **lift schemes** (pumping water uphill).
The big idea of AP water policy: bring **flood water of the Godavari** (surplus) to the **Krishna** (deficit) and then to **Rayalaseema** (drought). That is why **Polavaram → Prakasam Barrage → Srisailam / Rayalaseema** is repeated in news.

Project	River / place	Key facts
Dowleswaram (Godavari) Barrage	Rajahmundry	**Sir Arthur Cotton** built the anicut (1850s); feeds the **Godavari delta**; Cotton is revered as the 'father of Godavari delta'.
Polavaram (Indira Sagar)	Godavari, Polavaram district	**National project** under the 2014 Reorganisation Act; multipurpose (irrigation, power, drinking water); right canal links to the Krishna. Delays and cost rises are in the news (verify status).
Pattiseema lift	Godavari → Krishna	Lifts Godavari water into the Polavaram right canal to reach the Krishna (completed 2016).
Prakasam Barrage	Krishna, Vijayawada	Built 1957 replacing the 1855 anicut; feeds the Krishna delta.
Nagarjuna Sagar	Krishna (AP-Telangana border)	One of the world's largest **masonry** dams; completed 1960s; left canal feeds Guntur-Prakasam.

Srisailam	Krishna, Nandyal (near Kurnool border)	Dam with a big **hydel** station; reservoir water is lifted to Rayalaseema (**Handri-Neeva**, Pothireddypadu).
Tungabhadra Dam and **KC Canal**	Tungabhadra, Hospet (Karnataka); Kurnool	TB Dam is a joint AP-Karnataka project (**High Level Canal** to Anantapur, Kurnool, Kadapa; 2024 crest-gate failure). **KC (Kurnool-Cuddapah) Canal** from the Sunkesula barrage, about 300 km, built in the 1860s.
Handri-Neeva Sujala Sravanti	Lift from Srisailam backwaters	Brings Krishna water to **Kurnool, Anantapur, Chittoor** (drought-prone).
Somasila, Kandaleru, Telugu Ganga	Penna, Nellore; canal to Chennai	Telugu Ganga carries Krishna water through Somasila and Kandaleru reservoirs to **Chennai** (drinking water).
Vamsadhara, Thotapalli, Yeleru, Gundlakamma	North coast; Prakasam	Medium projects for **Srikakulam, Vizianagaram and Prakasam**; **Vamsadhara** has an inter-state dispute with Odisha.

National Waterway 4 (NW-4): Kakinada–Puducherry canals plus parts of the Godavari and Krishna; the old **Buckingham Canal** is part of it.
Types of irrigation (AP): canals strongest in the **Godavari, Krishna and Penna deltas**; **tanks** (Chittoor, Kadapa, Nellore); **wells and tube wells** (Guntur, Prakasam, Anantapur) and **lift schemes**. Over-pumping of groundwater is a serious issue in **Anantapur and Prakasam**.

ANDHRA PRADESH / KURNOOL CONNECTION

Kurnool's water map: Tungabhadra (Kurnool town), **KC Canal** (taking off at Sunkesula), **Srisailam right canal**, **Handri-Neeva** and **Veligonda** projects. **Kunderu** (Penna tributary) drains the Nandyal side. When the TB Dam or Srisailam reservoir levels fall, Kurnool and Anantapur farmers suffer first.
Vijayawada floods (Sept 2024) (Budameru + Krishna) show why flood management at **Prakasam Barrage** matters.

EXAM TRAPS

Dowleswaram = Godavari; **Prakasam** Barrage = Krishna; **Sunkesula** = Tungabhadra (KC canal).
Telugu Ganga takes **Krishna** water to Chennai; it does not use the Godavari.
Polavaram is a **national project**, not a state project.

2-MINUTE REVISION

East: canals. West: tanks, lifts. Godavari → Krishna → Rayalaseema.
Dowleswaram (Cotton), Prakasam Barrage, Srisailam, Nagarjuna Sagar, TB Dam, KC Canal, Handri-Neeva, Telugu Ganga, Polavaram.

CHECK YOURSELF

Q1. Barrage at Vijayawada: **Prakasam Barrage (Krishna)** · Q2. KC canal links: **Kurnool–Cuddapah (Tungabhadra)** · Q3. Lift scheme for drought areas: **Handri-Neeva**

CHAPTER 4 — AGRICULTURE AND ALLIED SECTORS

What grows where and why

IN SIMPLE WORDS (what / how / why)

Seasons: Kharif (Jun-Oct; rain-fed: rice, jowar, cotton, groundnut, red gram), **Rabi** (Nov-Mar; Bengal gram, maize, groundnut, rice in deltas), **Summer / zaid** (Mar-Jun; vegetables, watermelon, sunflower, rice with canal water).
Rule of thumb for answers: delta + canal water → rice, sugarcane, coconut; black soil → cotton, chilli, Bengal gram, sunflower; red soil + low rain → groundnut, millets, pulses; hills with rain → coffee, pepper, cashew; coast → fish and shrimp.
AP is the **'rice bowl'** of South India (Godavari-Krishna deltas) and a leader in **aquaculture** (shrimp, fish). The state exports **chilli, tobacco, shrimp and marine products**. Agriculture employs a large share of people although it contributes less to GSDP than services (verify current shares).

Crop / product	Main areas in AP	Remember
Rice	Godavari, Krishna, Guntur deltas; north coast	Kharif + rabi; canal fed
Groundnut	**Anantapur** (leading), Kurnool, Kadapa, Chittoor	Red soils, rain-fed
Cotton	Guntur, Palnadu, Prakasam, **Kurnool, Nandyal**	Black soil
Chilli	**Guntur** (Mirchi Yard, among the largest in Asia; verify), Prakasam, Palnadu, Krishna	Spice export crop
Tobacco (FCV)	Prakasam, East/West Godavari, Guntur	Cash crop; export; health concerns
Sugarcane / jaggery	Anakapalli, Visakhapatnam, Chittoor, East Godavari	**Anakapalle** is a big jaggery market
Bengal gram, sunflower, onion	**Kurnool, Nandyal, Prakasam**	Kurnool is a leading Bengal-gram and onion area

Mango	Chittoor, Krishna (Nuzvid), Vizianagaram, **Banaganapalle (Nandyal)**	Banganapalli = GI-tagged
Sweet orange, banana, papaya	Anantapur, **Kadapa**, Godavari districts	Horticulture, drip irrigation
Turmeric, tomato	Kadapa, Guntur; **Madanapalle** tomato market (Annamayya)	Mandis
Oil palm, coconut	West/East Godavari, Eluru; **Konaseema**	AP is a leading oil-palm state (verify)
Cashew	**Srikakulam (Palasa)**, Vizianagaram	Eastern Ghats coast
Coffee, pepper	**Araku / Alluri Sitarama Raju hills**	**Araku Valley Arabica** has a **GI tag**; grown by tribal farmers
Fish and shrimp	Krishna, West Godavari, Nellore, Prakasam, Kakinada	AP leads in **aquaculture** and marine exports
Poultry and milk	West Godavari/Eluru (eggs), Chittoor (milk)	Allied sector

Millets (jowar, ragi, korra) are traditional in Rayalaseema; **natural farming (zero budget)** and **Rythu Seva Kendras** (RSKs) are state initiatives (verify names under the current government). **Soil Health Card** (2015) and **PM-KISAN** are national schemes.

ANDHRA PRADESH / KURNOOL CONNECTION

Kurnool-Nandyal farming: black cotton soil (regur) on the plateau; **cotton, Bengal gram, sunflower, chillies, onion, jowar** are major crops; **paddy under KC canal and Tungabhadra canals**. **Rainfall is low and erratic (about 500-700 mm)**, so farmers move between **cotton and gram** depending on the monsoon; **dry farming** and **drip irrigation** are being promoted. **Kurnool market yard** is a major onion and groundnut mandi.
Krishnagiri mandal lies on the **plateau in Kurnool district**: black and red soils with rain-fed cotton, jowar and pulses are typical (check the local Mandal Agricultural Officer's cropping pattern).

EXAM TRAPS

Groundnut = **Anantapur**; chilli = **Guntur**; cashew = **Palasa (Srikakulam)**; coffee = **Araku (ASR)**.
Banganapalli mango is from **Banaganapalle in Nandyal** district.
Rice bowl = **Godavari-Krishna deltas** (coastal Andhra), not Rayalaseema.

2-MINUTE REVISION

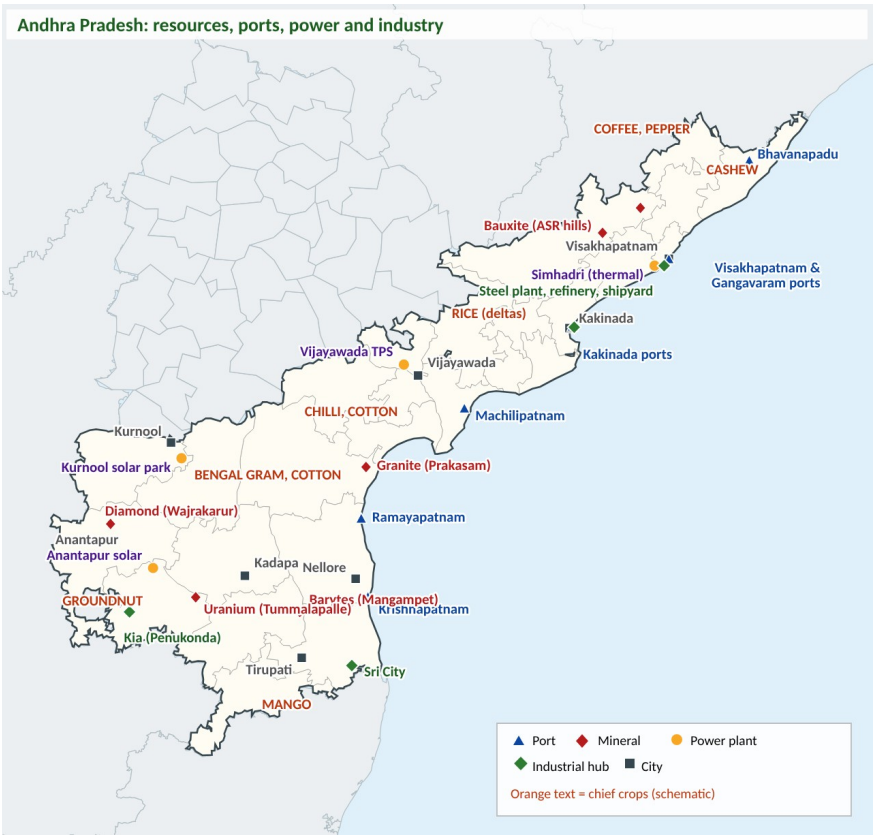
Delta → rice; black soil → cotton, gram; red soil → groundnut; hills → coffee, cashew; coast → shrimp.
Kharif / rabi / zaid. Anantapur groundnut; Guntur chilli; Kurnool gram and onion.

CHECK YOURSELF

Q1. Chilli hub: **Guntur** · Q2. Araku coffee tag: **GI** · Q3. Leading groundnut district: **Anantapur**

CHAPTER 5 — MINERALS AND ENERGY

Natural wealth and power



Map 5.1 Resources, ports, power and industry of AP (schematic)

IN SIMPLE WORDS (what / how / why)

Minerals are found in the old **Cuddapah basin** (Kadapa, Kurnool, Anantapur) and the **Eastern Ghats** (north). AP has **very little coal** (coal is mainly in Telangana at Singareni) but has **barytes, uranium, bauxite, limestone, asbestos, mica, granite** and **natural gas (KG basin)**.

Mineral	Where	Remember
Barytes	**Mangampet** (Annamayya/Kadapa)	One of the largest barytes deposits in the world; used in oil-well drilling mud
Uranium	**Tummalapalle** (Kadapa)	Large low-grade deposit; UCIL mine and mill
Bauxite	**Visakhapatnam hills / ASR** (Chintapalli, Galikonda)	Aluminium ore; mining is controversial for tribal areas
Limestone	**Palnadu, Kurnool, Kadapa, Anantapur**	Basis of the **cement** industry
Asbestos	**Pulivendula (Kadapa)**	Health concerns, mining largely stopped
Mica	**Nellore** (Gudur belt)	Historic mica belt
Diamond-bearing kimberlites	**Wajrakarur (Anantapur)**; Kurnool region geology	Only India's diamonds are in Panna (MP) and these small AP pipes
Granite	**Prakasam (Chimakurthy, Ongole)**, Srikakulam	Export industry
Natural gas, oil	**Krishna-Godavari (KG) basin** offshore Kakinada	ONGC, Reliance KG-D6; gas for power and fertiliser
Red Sanders, forest produce	Seshachalam, Nallamala	Biological resource (not mineral)

Power

Thermal: Simhadri (NTPC, Visakhapatnam), **Dr. NTTPS** (Vijayawada), **Rayalaseema TPP** (Kadapa), **Krishnapatnam** (Nellore). **Hydro: Srisailam, Nagarjuna Sagar**, **Upper/Lower Sileru** (ASR). **Solar and wind: Kurnool Ultra Mega Solar Park** (1,000 MW; Orvakal-Gani-Panyam), **Anantapur Ultra Mega Solar Park** (Talaricheruvu), **Kadapa Ultra Mega Solar Park** (Mylavaram); wind farms in **Anantapur, Kurnool, Kadapa**; **Pinnapuram** integrated renewable and pumped-storage project (Kurnool; verify size). **Nuclear:** none operating; **Kovvada (Srikakulam)** is a planned site. **Green hydrogen** hubs at **Visakhapatnam / Kakinada** are being planned (verify).

ANDHRA PRADESH / KURNOOL CONNECTION

Kurnool-Nandyal = AP's renewable energy centre: Kurnool Ultra Mega Solar Park, wind and the Pinnapuram pumped-storage

project, plus **limestone and cement** (Nandyal, Kadapa belt) and **Srisailam hydel** on the district edge. **Black soil plateau + high sunshine + flat land** makes solar practical.
Why does Rayalaseema suit solar? Little cloud cover, flat land, low-value dry land, and transmission lines on NH 44. **Why not rice or sugarcane?** Water shortage.

EXAM TRAPS

AP has **no major coal** (mention Singareni = Telangana).
Tummalapalle (**uranium**) is in **Kadapa**; Mangampet (**barytes**) is in the **Annamayya/Kadapa** area.
Simhadri = thermal (Visakhapatnam); **Srisailam** = hydel.

2-MINUTE REVISION

Barytes (Mangampet), uranium (Tummalapalle), bauxite (ASR), limestone (Palnadu, Kurnool), gas (KG basin).
Power: Simhadri, NTTPS, RTPP; hydro Srisailam; solar Kurnool, Anantapur, Kadapa.

CHECK YOURSELF

Q1. Barytes: **Mangampet** · Q2. Uranium: **Tummalapalle** · Q3. Largest solar park of Kurnool: **Kurnool Ultra Mega Solar Park**

CHAPTER 6 — INDUSTRIES, CORRIDORS AND PORTS

From the steel city to the Sri City cluster

IN SIMPLE WORDS (what / how / why)

Why is industry on the coast and in a few clusters? Ports for exports, flat land, rail and road links, a skilled port city (**Visakhapatnam**), and **industrial corridors** (planned belts with roads, power and land).
Corridors: Visakhapatnam–Chennai Industrial Corridor (VCIC) (part of the **East Coast Economic Corridor**, with Asian Development Bank help), **Chennai–Bengaluru Industrial Corridor (CBIC)** (with **Krishnapatnam** as a node) and the **Hyderabad–Bengaluru** link. **Orvakal (Kurnool)** and **Kopparthy (Kadapa)** are industrial nodes (verify corridor).

Cluster	Industries
Visakhapatnam	**Visakhapatnam Steel Plant (RINL)**, **HPCL refinery**, **Hindustan Shipyard**, **pharma city (Parawada)**, **APSEZ Atchutapuram** (apparel), IT, port-based industry
Kakinada–Godavari	**Kakinada SEZ**, fertiliser and petrochemicals (KG gas), ports, fishing harbour
Vijayawada–Guntur–Amaravati	Food processing, **textiles (Mangalagiri)**, cement, spinning, IT, government capital region
Nellore–Krishnapatnam–Sri City–Tirupati	**Krishnapatnam** port-led industry; **Sri City** (electronics, auto, FMCG); **electronics/mobile manufacturing** near Tirupati
Anantapur–Sri Sathya Sai	**Kia Motors (Penukonda)** and the auto cluster; **Dharmavaram silk saris**; solar and wind
Kurnool–Nandyal–Kadapa	**Cement and limestone**, renewable power, food processing (Orvakal node), mining

Ports (very important)

Port	Notes
Visakhapatnam	**Major port** (central government, Visakhapatnam Port Authority); a natural harbour; iron ore, coal, containers.
Gangavaram	Private deep-draught port near Visakhapatnam (part of the **Adani** ports group; verify).
Krishnapatnam	Private port in **Nellore**; large bulk and container cargo; CBIC node.
Kakinada (deep water and anchorage)	State-run/private; fertiliser, rice and agricultural exports.
Machilipatnam, Ramayapatnam, Bhavanapadu (Mulapeta)	New **non-major ports** being developed (verify construction status).

Handlooms and crafts (GI tags): Kondapalli toys, **Etikoppaka lacquer toys**, **Uppada Jamdani saris**, **Venkatagiri saris**, **Dharmavaram silk**, **Tirupati Laddu** (GI), **Banganapalli mango**, **Araku coffee**, **Srikalahasti Kalamkari**, **Lepakshi handicrafts** (verify the current GI list).
Tourism geography: Tirumala-Tirupati, **Srisailam** (Jyotirlinga), **Araku and Borra Caves**, **Gandikota** ('Grand Canyon of India', Penna, Kadapa), **Lepakshi**, **Belum Caves** (Kurnool), **Ahobilam, Mahanandi, Yaganti** (Nandyal), **Konaseema**, **Rushikonda** (Visakhapatnam beach).

ANDHRA PRADESH / KURNOOL CONNECTION

Kurnool's industry: cement and limestone, **agro-processing** (cotton ginning, groundnut and sunflower oil, onion), **renewable energy**, and the **Orvakal industrial node** next to the **Kurnool (Orvakal) airport** opened in 2021. **Kurnool is not on the coast**, so its exports go by road/rail to **Krishnapatnam or Chennai ports**.

Port	Notes

EXAM TRAPS

Visakhapatnam is the only **major** port in AP; the rest are non-major.
VCIC is **Visakhapatnam–Chennai**; CBIC is **Chennai–Bengaluru** (Krishnapatnam node).
Sri City is near Tirupati (Tirupati district), not in Chennai.

2-MINUTE REVISION

Steel, refinery, shipyard = Visakhapatnam. Sri City, Krishnapatnam = Tirupati–Nellore belt. Kia = Penukonda.
One major port: Visakhapatnam. Others: Gangavaram, Krishnapatnam, Kakinada; new: Machilipatnam, Ramayapatnam, Bhavanapadu.

CHECK YOURSELF

Q1. Major port of AP: **Visakhapatnam** · Q2. Kia plant: **Penukonda (Sri Sathya Sai)** · Q3. Corridor VCIC: **Visakhapatnam–Chennai**

CHAPTER 7 — TRANSPORT AND COMMUNICATIONS

Roads, rails, airports and waterways

Mode	Key facts
National Highways	**NH 16** (Kolkata–Chennai, the east-coast golden quadrilateral highway: Visakhapatnam–Rajahmundry–Vijayawada–Ongole–Nellore); **NH 44** (Srinagar–Kanyakumari: **Kurnool–Anantapur** in AP, the old NH 7); **NH 65** (Pune–Hyderabad–Vijayawada–Machilipatnam).
Railways	**South Coast Railway (SCoR) zone**, HQ **Visakhapatnam**, **started operations on 1 June 2026**; **4 divisions: Visakhapatnam, Vijayawada, Guntur, Guntakal**. Key junctions: **Vijayawada**, **Guntur**, **Guntakal**, **Renigunta**, **Gudur**, **Dhone** (Nandyal). East Coast Railway (Bhubaneswar) retains the north. Ongoing **Amaravati rail line** (verify).
Airports	**Visakhapatnam, Vijayawada, Tirupati, Rajahmundry, Kadapa, Kurnool (Orvakal), Puttaparthi**; **Bhogapuram (Vizianagaram)** international airport under construction (verify).
Waterways	**NW-4** (Kakinada–Puducherry canals, Godavari, Krishna); the **Buckingham Canal**; coastal shipping.
Ports	See Chapter 6.

ANDHRA PRADESH / KURNOOL CONNECTION

Kurnool-Nandyal connectivity: NH 44 (north–south), **NH 40** (Kurnool-Nandyal-Chittoor route), **Kurnool City and Dhone** railway stations on the **Guntakal division (SCoR)**, and the **Orvakal (Kurnool) airport** (UDAN). Kurnool is the 'gateway' between Hyderabad, Bengaluru and the coast.
For an officer: knowing which **NH, railway division and airport** serves your mandal is useful for disaster response, relief logistics and Spandana/PGRS cases on connectivity.

EXAM TRAPS

SCoR HQ is **Visakhapatnam** (not Vijayawada); divisions include **Guntakal** (Kurnool, Anantapur).
Kurnool is on **NH 44**, not NH 16.

2-MINUTE REVISION

NH 16 coast, NH 44 Kurnool-Anantapur, NH 65 Machilipatnam. SCoR 1 June 2026, 4 divisions. 7 airports + Bhogapuram (coming).

CHECK YOURSELF

Q1. SCoR HQ: **Visakhapatnam** · Q2. NH through Kurnool: **NH 44** · Q3. Division covering Kurnool: **Guntakal**

CHAPTER 8 — PEOPLE: POPULATION, URBANISATION AND TRIBES

Human geography of AP

IN SIMPLE WORDS (what / how / why)

Census 2011 (post-bifurcation AP): population about **4.95 crore (49.4 million)**; density about **304 per sq km**; sex ratio about **993 females per 1,000 males**; literacy about **67.4%**; decadal growth about **11%** (verify exact numbers; some sources differ slightly).
Urban share about 30% (verify). The next Census is due (2027, with caste enumeration; verify current plan).
Where do people live? Densest in the **deltas and Guntur-Krishna** belt; thinnest in the **hill tracts** (ASR) and dry **Rayalaseema**.
Large cities: Visakhapatnam (largest), Vijayawada, Guntur, Nellore, Kurnool, Tirupati, Kakinada, Rajahmundry (verify ranks).
Language and culture: Telugu (classical language since 2008), **Urdu** minority; **Kuchipudi** dance (Krishna district), **Burra Katha**, **Tholu Bommalata** (leather puppetry, Nimmalakunta, Anantapur).

Tribe / group	Where	Remember

Chenchu (PVTG)	**Nallamala forests: Kurnool/Nandyal, Prakasam, Palnadu**; also Telangana	Hunter-gatherers; **ITDA Srisailam** serves them
Konda Reddy, Savara, Jatapu, Gadaba, Bagata, Khond, Konda Dora, Koya, Porja	Eastern Ghats: **ASR, Parvathipuram Manyam, Srikakulam, Polavaram** area	**Scheduled Areas** (Fifth Schedule); ITDAs at Paderu, Seethampeta, Rampachodavaram
Yanadi, Yerukula, Sugali (Lambada)	Nellore, Chittoor, Rayalaseema	Large tribal groups in the plains

Why tribal areas matter to an officer: Fifth Schedule, **PESA 1996** (gram sabha powers), **Forest Rights Act 2006**, and the AP **Scheduled Areas Land Transfer Regulation (LTR 1/70)** protect tribal land from being sold to non-tribals. **ITDA** (Integrated Tribal Development Agency) implements schemes. Remote hill roads, health services and **bauxite mining** are recurring issues.

ANDHRA PRADESH / KURNOOL CONNECTION

In your mandal: Kurnool district has few notified tribal areas, but the **Chenchu** live in the Nallamala belt (Nandyal, Atmakur, Srisailam area); **Yerukula and Sugali** communities live across the plateau; **drought, migration** (seasonal labour to Hyderabad, Bengaluru) and **drinking water** are recurring Spandana issues.

2-MINUTE REVISION

Census 2011: about 4.95 crore, sex ratio about 993, literacy about 67.4%, urban about 30% (verify).
Chenchu (PVTG) in Nallamala; ITDAs; Fifth Schedule, PESA, FRA, LTR 1/70.

CHECK YOURSELF

Q1. PVTG of Nallamala: **Chenchu** · Q2. Act giving gram sabhas powers in Scheduled Areas: **PESA 1996** · Q3. AP largest city: **Visakhapatnam**

CHAPTER ★ — FINAL SELF-TEST: 30 QUESTIONS

Answers follow the table. Cover the answer column first.

#	Question	Answer
1	Coastline of AP (second longest in India):	**About 974 km**
2	Capital of Andhra State (1953-56):	**Kurnool**
3	Statutory capital of AP now:	**Amaravati**
4	Number of districts (31 Dec 2025):	**28**
5	New districts formed on 31 Dec 2025:	**Markapuram and Polavaram**
6	Highest point of AP:	**Arma Konda (about 1,680 m)**
7	Largest tiger reserve of India:	**Nagarjunasagar-Srisailam (about 3,728 sq km)**
8	Only biosphere reserve of AP:	**Seshachalam Hills**
9	Great Indian Bustard sanctuary:	**Rollapadu (Kurnool region)**
10	Ramsar freshwater lake of AP:	**Kolleru**
11	Second largest lagoon of India:	**Pulicat**
12	Father of the Godavari delta irrigation:	**Sir Arthur Cotton**
13	Barrage at Vijayawada:	**Prakasam Barrage (Krishna)**
14	Canal linking Kurnool and Cuddapah:	**KC Canal (Tungabhadra)**
15	Lift scheme to Rayalaseema from Srisailam:	**Handri-Neeva**
16	National project on the Godavari:	**Polavaram**
17	Water to Chennai from Krishna:	**Telugu Ganga**
18	Leading groundnut district:	**Anantapur**
19	Chilli hub:	**Guntur**
20	Coffee region with GI tag:	**Araku (ASR hills)**
21	Cashew hub (Srikakulam):	**Palasa**
22	Barytes:	**Mangampet**
23	Uranium:	**Tummalapalle (Kadapa)**
24	Bauxite:	**Visakhapatnam hills / ASR**
25	Only major port of AP:	**Visakhapatnam**
26	Kia plant:	**Penukonda (Sri Sathya Sai)**
27	Corridor from Visakhapatnam to Chennai:	**VCIC**

#	Question	Answer
28	SCoR zone HQ and start date:	**Visakhapatnam; 1 June 2026**
29	Highway through Kurnool:	**NH 44**
30	PVTG of the Nallamala forests:	**Chenchu**

NEXT STEPS

Scoring: 25+ strong · 20-24 good · below 20 re-read blue boxes. Send me the numbers you got wrong for a short revision set.
Redraw challenge: on a blank AP outline mark: 3 regions, Godavari, Krishna, Tungabhadra, Penna, Nallamala, Visakhapatnam, Krishnapatnam, Kurnool.
Next volume: Geography Vol 4 — Economic and Human Geography of India (resources, agriculture, industry, transport, population).